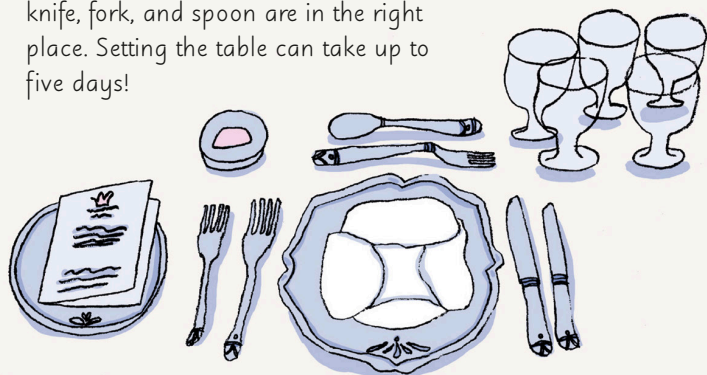


PREPARING A ROYAL BANQUET

As head of state, the Queen hosts official dinners for foreign leaders at state banquets. Each one takes weeks to prepare. Most state dinners are held at Buckingham Palace or Windsor Castle and everything must be just right for the 150–160 guests. Staff make sure each seat, glass, plate, and knife, fork, and spoon are in the right place. Setting the table can take up to five days!



Living a private life was difficult, especially with the fear of terrorist attacks. Police protected the Queen day and night, but there were scares. On June 13, 1981, crowds cheered for Elizabeth at the Trooping the Colour parade. She was riding her trusted horse Burmese. Suddenly, shots rang out. Startled, the horse skittered. The Queen used all her skill as a horsewoman to stay in the saddle and